

When pointing to extremely small objects, like the small box in the upper left hand corner of a window, it's useful to know that the arrow's "hot spot" is at its tip. If the tip of the arrow is inside the box, you're pointing to it. If the tip is out of the box, you're not pointing to it—even if some other part of the pointer is in the box. So when we say to point to an object, we mean to put the tip of the arrow on it.

By itself, pointing isn't too useful—it merely tells the computer what object you want to work with. To actually start working with an object, you need another mouse action—clicking.

Clicking

Clicking is simple—a quick press and release of the mouse button. Clicking does different things depending on what program you're in and where you click. In the Finder, clicking an icon turns it black (we call that "highlighting" or "selecting" the icon). Clicking various parts of windows also has interesting results. Clicking on text in a document moves the insertion point to the clicked location (don't worry, we won't talk about the insertion point until Chapter 5, so you haven't missed anything). Clicking on a button in a dialog box activates that button. And so on.

By the way, in Desktop-speak, you don't click *on* an object, you just click it. (You don't "click the mouse on the Q1 icon," you just "click the Q1 icon.") This usage encourages you to think of the mouse and the on-screen pointer as being not just linked but literally *the same thing*.

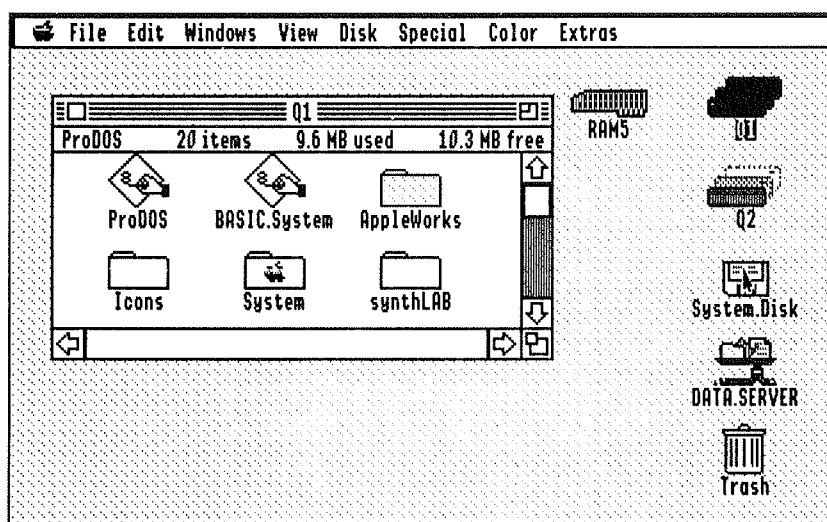


Figure 4A—Pointing to an Icon in the Finder